

Since choosing software engineering as my career, I have been searching for my niche in the industry. I began at the highest level of the stack. I've designed UIs and published a research paper on human computer interaction. Building web interfaces intrigued me to build the backend and data layer, where I designed APIs and implemented auth and caching. My internship at a cloud infrastructure team in Summer 2025 was an enlightening experience where I solved problems at scale with cloud native technologies. Fallen in love with the problem that Kubernetes solves and its community, I architected my own Kubernetes cluster to deploy personal projects and even contributed upstream to Kubernetes. I went further down to work closely to the metal and operating system, as I entered CMU's master's program with a focus on distributed systems.

Journeying through the modern technology stack from top to bottom, I have built the frontend, backend, and the infrastructure to run them on. Counterproductively to my niche-searching, there wasn't a part that I didn't enjoy learning. Each layer of the stack came with different problems but taught the same lesson:

There's always more than what I know.

I've come to think that in today's world, maybe what I need is the passion and vision, not a niche. And I believe Datadog is one of the few places where none of that breadth goes to waste. The product is infrastructure at its core, ingesting telemetry from thousands of customers at a scale that is a distributed systems problem before it is anything else. But it is also a product an engineer opens in the middle of an outage and needs to give them the answer in seconds. I have worked both of those sides, building a Go API that scatter gathered metrics across five Kubernetes clusters with OpenTelemetry at UKG and shipping a role-based frontend at Huddle Surety where the whole point was that two kinds of users need to see different things. I want an internship where I own a slice end-to-end and have to prove it works, and I would like that slice to be part of the tooling that other engineers depend on when something is broken.